



Assess and plan tourism opportunities for local communities

D2.TCS.CL5.02

Trainee Manual



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainees' chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Assess and plan tourism opportunities for local communities

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Assess and plan tourism opportunities for local communities in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TCS.CL5.02

Nominal Hours:

50

Element 1: Research local tourism opportunities

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Consult with the local community to obtain their involvement and input
- 1.2 Identify possible tourism opportunities for local communities
- 1.3 Identify research needs for the local communities
- 1.4 Conduct research on general tourism trends and data
- 1.5 Conduct research on the local area and communities

Element 2: Interpret research results

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Analyse the information collected from all sources
- 2.2 Identify impacts of the research
- 2.3 Communicate research results to stakeholders
- 2.4 Use research results and feedback to guide future actions
- 2.5 Confirm tourism opportunities to be pursued with the local communities and other relevant stakeholders

Element 3: Prepare formal draft plans

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Seek assistance from external experts and relevant personnel
- 3.2 Ensure draft plans reflect community interests and concerns
- 3.3 Ensure plans reflect the business plans and direction of the host enterprise
- 3.4 Identify training needs and training delivery methodologies
- 3.5 Identify physical infrastructure needs for the local communities and the host enterprise
- 3.6 Identify resources that need to be supplied to the local communities to facilitate implementation of plans
- 3.7 Incorporate the environmental, social, cultural and economic interests of the local communities into the plans
- 3.8 Ensure plans are culturally and environmentally sensitive
- 3.9 Maintain ongoing communication and consultation throughout the planning process
- 3.10 Develop a clear strategic and tactical focus for plans that are made

Element 4: Present draft plans

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Submit plans for consideration by the local communities and other relevant key stakeholders
- 4.2 Amend plans on the basis of feedback received
- 4.3 Re-present revised plans for approval

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Research local tourism opportunities				
1.1	Consult with the local community to obtain their involvement and input	1.0, 1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Identify possible tourism opportunities for local communities	1.2	3, 4	2
1.3	Identify research needs for the local communities	1.3	5	3
1.4	Conduct research on general tourism trends and data	1.4	6, 7	4
1.5	Conduct research on the local area and communities	1.5	8, 9	5
Element 2: Interpret research results⁶				
2.1	Analyse the information collected from all sources	2.1	10	6
2.2	Identify impacts of the research	2.2	11, 12	7
2.3	Communicate research results to stakeholders	2.3	13	8
2.4	Use research results and feedback to guide future actions	2.4	14, 15	9
2.5	Confirm tourism opportunities to be pursued with the local communities and other relevant stakeholders	2.5	16, 17, 18	10

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 3: Prepare formal draft plans				
3.1	Seek assistance from external experts and relevant personnel	3.1	19	11
3.2	Ensure draft plans reflect community interests and concerns	3.2	21, 22, 23	12
3.3	Ensure plans reflect the business plans and direction of the host enterprise	3.3	24, 25	13
3.4	Identify training needs and training delivery methodologies	3.4	26, 27	14
3.5	Identify physical infrastructure needs for the local communities and the host enterprise	3.5	28, 29	15
3.6	Identify resources that need to be supplied to the local communities to facilitate implementation of plans	3.6	30, 31, 32	16
3.7	Incorporate the environmental, social, cultural and economic interests of the local communities into the plans	3.7	33, 34	17
3.8	Ensure plans are culturally and environmentally sensitive	3.8	35, 36	18
3.9	Maintain ongoing communication and consultation throughout the planning process	3.9	37, 38	19
3.10	Develop a clear strategic and tactical focus for plans that are made	3.10	39, 40, 41, 42	20
Element 4: Present draft plans				
4.1	Submit plans for consideration by the local communities and other relevant key stakeholders	4.1	43, 44, 45, 46	21
4.2	Amend plans on the basis of feedback received	4.2	47, 48	22
4.3	Re-present revised plans for approval	4.3	49, 50	23

Glossary

Assess	Evaluate
Data manipulating	Reorganising, rearranging data
Catalogue	Classify, categorise
Emerging trend	Developing movement, fashion
Impact	Influence
Infrastructure	Basic structures and facilities
KPI	Key Performance Criteria
Market analysis	Study of structure and attractiveness of a market
Market research	Research into consumers preferences and needs
Media release	Communication to release a newsworthy item
Plan	Proposal
Policy	Concise formal statement which indicates how an organization will act in a particular area of its operation
Primary data	New/fresh information generated as a result of new research activities
Procedure	A particular way of doing things. Normally in reference to implementing a policy.
Qualitative data	Answers the 'why' questions: also known as soft data
Quantitative data	Statistical data: also known as hard data
Reflect	Reproduce, replicate
Scope of authority	The authority given to you by management to make decisions and take action on behalf of the venue without recourse to management
Secondary data	Data/information which already exists in reports, databases, business documentation or in other sources
Stakeholder	Person , group, organisation, community with an interest in the plan

SWOT analysis	Analysis of Strengths-Weaknesses-Opportunities and Threats
Tourism leakage	Tourism revenue lost to local community
Trivialisation	Loss of importance
Unintended	Different

Please note that this Glossary is not exhaustive. Some words or phrases may also appear in the Glossary that do not appear in the training resources but have been made available to the Trainer as an extra resource if and when required.

Element 1:

Research local tourism opportunities

1.1 Consult with the local community to obtain their involvement and input

Introduction



Tourism is one of the world fastest growing industries and developing regional and local tourism is an integral part of most country's tourism master plans.

To successfully develop and promote any region, one of the first crucial steps is to conduct research to identify local tourism opportunity in the selected region, area, local communities.

The ongoing consultation process with all identified relevant stakeholders to determine and plan potential tourism opportunities for local communities is the corner stone of this unit.

The first section explains ways to best conduct research local tourism opportunities.

For the research process to benefit all parties, the following steps are recommended.

Local community consultation

Consulting with the local communities involved is the key to success. It is critical to:

- First identify all parties
- Then organise and publicise the consultation process
- Followed by seeking feedback
- And record input.

Identify local community parties

Their lives will be impacted by changes in tourism activity and tourism presence in their community and gaining their support is necessary for the success of the project. They include:

- Local tourism businesses such as:
 - Tourism operators:
 - Hotels, accommodation venues
 - Food and beverage venues
 - Attractions
 - Tour operators and travel agencies
 - Support transport services : taxis, buses company, car rentals

- Local businesses such as:
 - Real estate agents
 - Supermarkets, grocers
 - Pharmacies
 - Banks
 - Petrol stations
- Community organisations, group such as:
 - Elders
 - Traditional communities on ancestral lands.
 - Extended families in urban or rural settings
 - Salvation army
 - Lions club
 - Rotary club
 - Local sports club
- Other community decision influencers such as:
 - Doctors, Chemists, Hospital
 - Fire, Police
 - Trade unions
 - School, colleges and universities representatives
 - Religious organizations leaders
 - Groups with common cultural links and interests
 - Individuals who identify with and are accepted by a particular group
- Local authorities ranging from:
 - Lord mayor
 - City council members
- Other stakeholders such as:
 - Official, governmental travel and tourism bodies relevant to the country, and/or region
 - Travel and Tourism associations and peak representatives
 - And others with responsibility and interests in issues such as tourism, employment, transportation, the regional and local economy.
- The media who have a role in disseminating information, promoting initiatives and providing a forum for discussion and motivating engagement with initiatives.



Conduct community consultation

When stakeholders have been identified, the next step is to consultation to determine potential tourism opportunities mutually acceptable to the local communities, authorities and the business operators.

Determining the best way to communicate with all relevant parties depends on:

- The nature of the stakeholders:
 - Which communication medium they prefer

For example local government authorities might be more familiar with electronic communication whether to reach the wide local community, meetings in the local town hall will be a more effective way to start the dialogue.

When communicating with the local communities, it is important to:

- Be clear on the purpose of the meeting
- Be honest
- Communicate in a timely manner
- Advertising and promoting the meeting with enough lead time for all the interested parties to make arrangements to attend
- Organise meetings, workshops and seminars:
 - In a neutral location
 - Easy to access
 - At a convenient time for most concerned stakeholders.



In order to 'set the scene', when starting the consultation process, the following topics must be clearly presented, explained and opened for discussion:

- Potential advantages, impacts such as:
 - Economic benefits to local community
 - Improved local facilities
 - Employment opportunities
 - Cultural benefits including cultural preservation
 - Visitors education
 - Greater understanding between host and visitor cultures

- Potential disadvantages such as:
 - Trivialisation of culture
 - Effect on social structures and lifestyles
 - Environmental damage
 - Loss of privacy
 - Exposure to the dangers accompanying any influx of tourists
 - Reduced ability to use and/or enjoy traditional facilities and locations

It is important to remember that those are generic potential advantages and disadvantages and consultation and research will determine which ones might apply to the local communities.

Actively seek advice in relation to potential tourism related opportunities

The local community knowledge of:

- The area
- The facilities , infrastructure already in place
- The type of visitors they already have , if applicable
- The weather pattern, seasons
- The local events
- General common local attitude towards tourism.



This provides them with a recent and in depth understanding of any potential local tourism opportunities. These might be for example the development of a local festival into a regional one, or the opening of a large coastal resort.

Actively seeking advice means that the host organisation must become truly engaged with the local community and all other identify stakeholders.

In addition of meetings, it is recommended to:

- Conduct seminars and workshops
- Formal and informal interviews, chats with residents and key local representative.

Record all input by all contributors

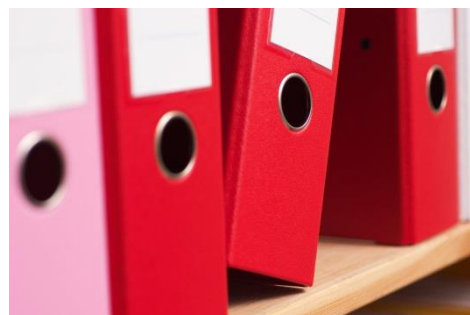
All data gathered needs to be recorded straightaway in order to be used for the assessing phase of the project.

The following means can be used:

- Written and/or recorded formal meetings notes
- Informal notes from meetings, chats with residents and key local representatives kept in hard or soft copy
- Comments on host organisation website if applicable.

Essential considerations are:

- Always note names and contact details, whenever available, of those who provide data so they can be followed up with if/as necessary at a late stage
- Ensuring suitable security provisions and protocols exist for accessing, storing and using data
- Enter data promptly, in a timely manner, making sure nothing is ignored or overlooked, with the appropriate skills in:
 - Relevant software and hardware
 - File , data conversion and management
 - Data management
 - Data retrieving and archiving
- Checking the data is valid and has been obtained with data gathering protocols
- Clarify any ambiguous data
- Determining if enough information has been capture to conduct the research and take action to obtain supplementary information if required
- Maintain confidentiality of the data by restricting access to only authorised persons
- Retain original paper based documents.



1.2 Identify possible tourism opportunities for local communities

Introduction

Once the scene is set and you have established an initial dialogue with all identified interested parties, the next step is to identify potential local tourism opportunities.

Possible tourism opportunities

The type and scope of the opportunities will vary depending on:

- The country, region and location, targeted area:
 - The stage of tourism development
 - The region, location accessibility
- The size of the local area targeted

The opportunities might include:

- Expansion and/or development of:
 - Tourism retailing operations and tour operations as they already have industry specific knowledge to promote and sell the area and can incorporate various distribution channels from:
 - Retail travel agent able to promote and sell from tours to accommodation and events

- Tour wholesaler website, brochure to book the holiday in turn using an
- Inbound tour operator to book separate element of the tour itinerary from accommodation to tour who then contacts
- Local tour operator to book the services directly
- Accommodation development ranging from:
 - Launching an advertising a national campaign to promote the numerous bed and breakfast venues of a seaside coastal resort
 - Planning the development of a large coastal resort
 - Developing an ecotourism lodge next to a national park
- Another method to identify local tourism opportunities is to invite external tour operators to the area so they can see first-hand what the location has to offer. Due to their experience and market knowledge such as changes in visitors' expectations and emerging needs, wants and preferences, they might uncover potential opportunities that have been previously overlooked such as developing a theme for the region as a specific destination for diving, health retreat or a cycling holiday.



Direct community involvement. People are the lifeblood of tourism and most tourism opportunities include community involvement in:

- Providing local staff for external tourism operations ranging from direct operations such as:
 - Ongoing employment of staff working in a destination park, museum, resort
 - Part time, casual employment of staff working on events, festivals
 - Flow on impact staff employed to build roads, hotels, transportation
- Being actively involved in the training related to the final plans by:
 - Providing and/or support the training delivery prior to and after the opening of a 5 star resort to impart the required skills and knowledge to work in various departments.

1.3 Identify research needs for the local communities

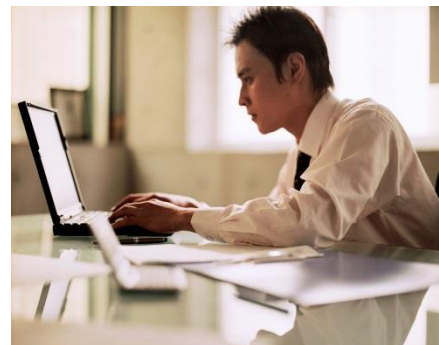
Introduction

Subsequent to the initial consultation stage and identification of potential tourism opportunities, a clear identification of the research needs to be conducted in order to become familiar with and understand the existing local tourism background.

Research needs

To establish the research needs, the host organisation needs to get a clear picture of the current situation, understand the local environment and needs to carefully consider:

- Present community business focus that may range from:
 - Minimum tourism infrastructure such as camping grounds
 - Only tourism focus activities being an annual festival or a weekly arts and craft Sunday morning market
 - Potential tourism opportunities identified as a result of the first round of consultation
- The research process needs to cover:
 - Research and identification of products and services gaps
 - Research existing local market size and market share
 - Research competitors performance
 - Research what the actual customers' needs are
 - Research products and service to meet those needs
 - Research and evaluate potential for future sustainable developments
 - Research new and innovative approaches
- Integration of the tourism possibilities within the existing framework, organisational business directions and operational plans:
 - For the host community: in relation to:
 - National, regional, local existing tourism plan , if applicable
 - Local government, council operational plan, if applicable
 - For the host organisation: in relation to:
 - Its own operation and business plans
 - Its other projects and research being conducted at the same time



- Project management considerations: the research aims and methods needs to be clearly determined in order to lead to a positive outcome for all concerned parties. They include:
 - Agreeing on the aims of research with key stakeholders and local community as a result of extensive consultation and might look at:

- Expanding further camping facilities
- Developing the area as a 'specific' tourism destination such as ecotourism or adventure tourism

For both of those examples research will need to look at:

- Current situation, existing infrastructure, local amenities and staffing
- All requirements for any expansion

- Determining which sources of research will be used such as:

- Seeking views and opinions from stakeholders – which may require:

- Holding consultation sessions/meetings
- Actively soliciting feedback
- Conducting competitions to elicit ideas
- Generating public discussion – involving:
 - Media presence
 - Social media interactions
 - Appearances of key persons at meetings and public presentations
 - Development and circulation of materials (handouts, media releases, social media posts) to provide information for discussion



- Investigating the history of the local people/community in relation to tourism and its impacts – by:
 - Conducting desktop research – such as:
 - Internet searches
 - Reading existing reports and records – which will provide secondary data and indicate where primary data may be required to assist with the research process (see below)
 - Reading print-based articles from newspapers
 - Reading relevant history and other texts
 - Talking to identified key personnel – such as elders and designated community representatives

- Setting realistic timelines by ensuring that the required deadline for completing the identified research needs is remains viable and realistic
- Preparing professionally written plans including:
 - Detailed tasks, activities
 - Setting realistic timelines for completing the:
 - Research stage
 - Results interpretation stage
 - Formal draft plans preparation
 - Plans presentation
 - Clearly allocate:
 - Responsibilities
 - Resources required
 - Making sure that the research is being conducted by experienced and trustworthy staff:
 - Checking that the people applying the survey instruments are applying them correctly, including following-up on issues raised by the respondents
 - Allocating a realistic budget research based on previous projects and checking that budgetary limitations are being observed, where applicable



Most importantly:

- Agree on the aim of the research with local communities and stakeholders as discussed during the initial consultation stage.

1.4 Conduct research on general tourism trends and data

Introduction

This topic and the next deal with research methodology and effectiveness on a generic then local level.

Research can be conducted via various media depending on the type of research and the information being researched.

It might include:

- Questionnaires and surveys
- Conducting interviews:
 - With groups and communities :face-to-face or telephone
 - With individuals; face to face or by telephone
- Focus groups
- Electronic counters, where applicable
- Desktop research
- Observing people and actions.

General trends and data

They can be obtained from various sources and cover numerous topics and should include:

Existing data, also called secondary research data as it already exists from:

- Databases, free to use data sources from government and peak industry sources such as, in Australia for example:
 - Tourism Australia:
 - <http://www.tourism.australia.com>
 - Tourism Research Australia:
 - <http://www.ret.gov.au/tourism>
 - National Tourism Alliance members:
 - <http://www.tourismalliance.org>
 - Local agency such as the local Tourism Office such as Melbourne, Victoria, Australia:
 - <http://www.visitmelbourne.com>
 - Regional , state agency such as Tourism Victorian in the state of Victoria (Australia)
 - Corporate:
 - www.tourism.vic.gov.au
 - Consumer:
 - www.visitvictoria.com



- Internal and external business reports
- Findings of research which has already been undertaken
- Internet
- Media articles
- Anecdotal evidence provided by people.

Primary data

When the secondary data has been read and analysed there is very often a need to obtain primary research data.

Primary research data is generated to fill gaps in the knowledge which exist after the secondary research data has been read and analysed. It is new, freshly-generated data.

Primary research data may be captured through the:

- Meetings
- Seminars
- Workshops
- Interviews conducted by the host enterprise.



Qualitative and quantitative data

Research data may be further classified into qualitative and quantitative data.

Qualitative data

Qualitative data is also known as 'soft' data.

It captures information about:

- Feelings and opinions
- Reasons people do what they do
- Reasons people do not do certain things.
- Previously planned and/or conducted local marketing activities focused on the local communities:
 - Nature of the marketing activity
 - Status: started, completed?
 - Was it a success, why?
 - Was it a failure, why?
- Similar initiatives in similar locations:
 - Nature of the project, initiative
 - Project status: started, completed?
 - Was it a success, why?
 - Was it a failure, why?

Qualitative data seeks to answer ‘Why?’ questions – such as:

- Why do people want to travel to a certain place?
- Why do people hold the opinion they have about tourism and tourists?
- Why would tourism be good or bad for the local community?
- Why would tourists want to come to the area?

Quantitative data

Quantitative data is also known as ‘hard’ data.

Quantitative data seeks to answer ‘quantifiable’ questions – such as:

- How often would people travel/have they travelled to a certain place?
- How many days would they spend in a place/how many days have they spent?
- How much money would they spend/have they spent in the areas they visited?
- How many bed nights would be required/have been sold?
- How many crimes involving tourists have been reported?
- What financial costs would attach to proceeding with a tourism initiative?

It captures information about:

- Facts
- Statistics and figures
- Percentages and ratios such as:
 - Tourists, visitors’ arrival patterns: weekends, week days, holidays
 - Tourists, visitors spending patterns: how much on average, where
 - Tourist, visitors’ stay and visitation patterns: where do they prefer to go, how often?



Desktop research

This is a fairly recent research tool.

With the Internet or World Wide Web, information from all corners of the globe can be found. The Internet is a huge database of information that can be searched to locate information pertinent to the research.

Websites

The following give more information on research and associated terms and techniques:

- <http://www.business.qld.gov.au/business/starting/market-customer-research/market-research-basics/market-research-methods> - Market research methods
- <http://www.allbusiness.com/marketing/market-research/1287-1.html> - Five basic methods of research
- <http://www.smetoolkit.org/smetoolkit/en/content/en/196/Market-Research-Techniques> - Market research techniques
- <http://www.marketingdonut.co.uk/marketing/market-research/qualitative-or-quantitative-which-method-is-for-you-> - Qualitative or quantitative market research: which is for you?
- http://www.tutor2u.net/business/gcse/marketing_research_quantqual.html - Market research: quantitative and qualitative
- <http://www.b2binternational.com/research/methods/faq/whats-the-difference-between-quantitative-and-qualitative-research/> - Quantitative and qualitative research: what's the difference?

1.5 Conduct research on general tourism trends and data

Introduction

Following on from researching general tourism trends and data, specific research on the local area and communities will facilitate the assessment and planning stages. In addition, it will also assist in gaining the local support.

The research on the local area and communities can be divided between data gathering, clarification and data recording

Data gathering and clarification

Following the initial consultation meetings and the information gathered, research contextualisation for the local communities involves seeking identification of preferences, reasons for those preferences and can involve:

- Using and analysing further the data gathered when conducting research on general tourism and during the initial consultation leads to identifying useful local data such as:
 - Local visitors numbers
 - Local visitors arrival numbers
 - Local visitors spending patterns
- Offering alternatives, making suggestions and providing additional explanations as required such as:
 - Following research on potential opportunities of local ecotourism development due to the area being next to a national park, additional data shows additional benefits to a more sustainable economy: it is a developing area and more benefits it appears that it will attract additional government grants and will enhance the public favourable awareness of the region, area



- Building from the first step covered : consultation with the local community , the research needs to identify:

- Local communities preferences:

- Preferred type of tourism:

Do they favour building on existing visitors' type if they have a base of week end visitors coming for the Sunday morning local arts and craft market: Why? Why not

Do they want to become of 'specific destination': ecotourism, adventure, arts and craft, local culture: Why? Why not?

Do they want to have an agreement with one specific tour operator with the potential to bring coaches tours to visit the local attractions: museum, place of worship: Why? Why not?

What is the position in regards to the potential opening of a large coastal resort?

Additional explanations might be required in view of some research findings to ensure the clarity of information and that ongoing dialogue are taking place.

The local communities preferences and their justification must be recorded and taken into account during the next phase of the project: the research interpretation

Identifying and cataloguing existing local resources is another research component. This information will be used to get a clear picture of the local area and communities potential needs.

Resources can be:

- Industry based such as:
 - Local government data bases
 - Local tourism associations or other industry bodies data bases and knowledge
 - Potential for grants and other assistance at a national, regional or state level
 - Sponsorship and/or joint ventures with tourism businesses, operators
 - Expertise of those likely to participate in and implement final plans such as local authorities.



Community such as:

- Preparedness and readiness of individual tourism operators to contribute to and support plans
- Local skills profile: existing level versus required level of training required for the plan implementation: from extra park rangers training due to 'environment park' development to hospitality training due to the opening a coastal resort
- Extent and condition of local infrastructure: from local airport to roads and public amenities and buildings such as visitors centres, hotels
- Current market position of the destination and community: as determined when completing research on current tourism situation, market mix, market mix knowledge, and consumer trends and visitors peaks and troughs cycles.

All the data collected now needs to be analysed and interpreted.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Arrange, under the guidance of your trainer, a visit to either a regional, tourism office or an organisation with experience in researching and consulting with all identified stakeholders to determine and prepare plans aiming to provide opportunities mutually acceptable to the local communities, authorities and business operators. Make sure you get information covering the research stage, research interpretation and the draft plans preparation together with concrete examples that will help you to complete your draft plan

Progressive work project: Tourism opportunities for local communities

Your company has been chosen to assess and plan tourism opportunities for a nominated local community. You have been selected to be the key researcher and writer for the draft plan.

You are required to conduct research, interpret it, and develop a formal draft plan that should consist of the following sections:

Executive summary:

An executive summary gives a clear idea of what is in the plan and should be one page consisting of the key elements of the plan summarizing the:

- A clear description of the purpose of the formal draft plan
- Development stage
- Suggested Implementation stage.

Once you have identified the local community of your choice, you are required to research local tourism opportunities by:

1.1 Consulting with the local community to obtain their involvement and input. Clearly explain how you plan to:

- Arrange meetings with all concerned parties
- Conduct those meetings explaining:
 - Generic potential advantages
 - Generic potential disadvantages , impacts of tourism opportunities for the local community
- Seek input and advice in relation to tourism related opportunities
- Record the information gathered.

1.2. Identifying possible tourism opportunities for the local community:

- From tourism retailing operations to tour operations, accommodation development.

1.3. Identifying research needs for the local community by:

- Conducting an audit of the current business focus: clearly list the steps you will follow to conduct the audit
- Meeting with identified key stakeholders and the local community to:
 - Agree on the aim of the research
 - Set realistic deadlines and allocate responsibilities and resources
 - Determine research sources that will be used.

1.4. Conduct research on general tourism trends and data to support the local research by:

- Accessing existing available data
- Conducting primary and secondary research
- Consider quantitative and qualitative data related to your chosen local community.

1.5 Conduct research on the local area and communities in order to contextualise the potential tourism opportunities by:

- Generating additional information to add to initial community meetings
 - Cataloguing existing facilities
 - Determining skills levels and potential workers available in final plans
 - Identifying local community preferences and reasons for those preferences.
-

Summary

Research local tourism opportunities

- Consult with the local community to obtain their involvement and input:
 - Arrange and conduct meetings with all concerned parties
 - Actively seek input from all concerned parties
 - Seek advice related to potential tourism opportunities
 - Record input
 - Explain potential advantages and disadvantages of tourism opportunities
- Identify possible tourism opportunities for local communities:
 - Tourism retailing operations
 - Tour operations including external tour operators
 - Accommodation development
 - Community involvement in staff provision and training
 - Conduct research
- Identify research needs for local communities:
 - Consider current local business focus
 - Integrate tourism possibilities with existing plans and goals
 - Agree on research aim with local community
 - Set timelines and responsibilities
 - Determine research sources to use
- Conduct research on general tourism trends and data:
 - Consult existing data
 - Conduct primary and secondary research
 - Consider quantitative, qualitative, hard and soft data
 - Arrival and spending patterns and stay and visitations patterns, activity and usage patterns
 - Identify previous marketing activities, success and failure
 - Investigate already planned and implemented local communities initiatives
 - Study similar initiatives in similar locations
- Conduct research on the local area and community:
 - Supplement findings by generating additional input and information
 - Offer alternatives, suggestions, explanations
 - Record local community reservations
 - Determine existing skill levels.

Element 2: Interpret research results

2.1 Analyse the information collected from all sources

Introduction

Once all relevant information has been collected, it needs to be interpreted to determine all potential opportunities and their impact.

How to analyse data

Working with research data is also referred to as 'manipulating data'.

Activities commonly involved when manipulating data will address:

Classifications of all collected data whether it is statistical or other and may be assembled around criteria such as:

- Measures which are relevant to the topic which is the focus of the research – this may include:
 - Monetary terms and amounts
 - Data sources
 - Dates
- Industry terminology – such as (for example) 'bed nights', 'single stays', 'carrying capacity', 'domestic tourist' and 'tourism expenditure' as defined precisely for the purposes of the research
- Community-related terms of identified concern – such as (for example) 'crimes', 'traffic density', 'employment', 'social issues'
- Separation of data by type – which may separate:
 - Quantitative data from qualitative data
 - Primary data from secondary data
- Classification by individual hypothesis or question numbers – as identified on surveys, questionnaires or other research tools
- Division of respondents and their answers into required demographic classification – according to demographic characteristics identified prior to the research.



Note: allowance should always be made to include new classifications as the collection and manipulation of data occurs because commonly there will be factors and issues emerging from the research which were not anticipated, predicted or allowed for in the initial classification.

Data verification which can include:

- Making sure the raw data supplied is sufficient according to the pre-determined parameters/requirements of the research
- Evaluating input from stakeholders taking into consideration potential bias that may exist
- Ensuring the data is correctly entered into the appropriate classification
- Clarifying unclear information with those who captured/generated the data – to make sure the facts recorded genuinely reflect the input made by the respondents, and to ignore material and data that is not verifiable
- Following up as required – to collect additional information where insufficient data has been generated or validating contributions that appear suspect.

Data analysis and interpretation to make sense of the information collected and can include:

- Performing a range of arithmetic, mathematical and statistical calculations and functions with the data – this can include:
 - Creating totals
 - Generating ratios and percentages
 - Developing tables and other statistical or diagrammatic representations of the information
 - Classifying the results of the research
 - Quantifying the data
 - Identifying trends
 - Comparing outcomes/findings.



Production of a report on the research including findings and recommendations

These findings and recommendations need to:

- Address the questions posed by the research – they need to shed light on the reasons the research was undertaken in the first place: a viable finding may be that more research needs to be done
- Identify and/or provide evidence to support the SWOT (Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats) analysis components for the topic/s of the research – so a more 'informed' platform for action is established. The analysis itself that will be covered in another section
- Produce a set of conclusions which can be presented to stakeholders – for discussion
- Be written and formulated in such a way they allow or enable informed decisions to be made and suitable action to be taken – to move the initiative forward.

Note that it is perfectly acceptable for the findings of some research to conclude:

- More research needs to be undertaken before an intelligent decisions can be made – this may be required to address what is deemed to be insufficient data, or a situation where the context/circumstance has fundamentally changed since the initial research/formulation of the hypothesis began
- Different research needs to done – to capture data on areas which have merged as being important/necessary, or to seek contributions from different classifications of respondents

- The findings of the initial research have indicated a need for more/different hypotheses or questions to be raised and addressed – because the original topics failed to encompass what emerged as the real considerations to be addressed
- The initial aim/objective of those who authorised the research cannot be achieved – that is, there is always the possibility the research can find the proposal to implement a tourism initiative and/or a host community awareness program should not proceed.

2.2 Identify impacts of the research

Introduction

Once the data has been analysed, the next step is to identify the potential social, environmental, economic and cultural impact the plans might have on the local communities:

To provide an unbiased picture, it is important to investigate both potential positive and negative consequences.

Economic and social impacts

Changing local conditions may result in the following positive economic and social consequences:

- Creation of employment both direct employment within the tourism industry and indirect employment such as in retail, transportation. This in turn leads to the ‘multiplier effect’ : wages money spent on goods and services, creating more jobs
- Maintenance, growth and improvement in local facilities such as schools, hospitals due to the extra tax revenues such as airport and hotel taxes
- Improved public transport systems.

However the following potential negative impacts need to be considered:

- Negative effect on social structure caused by the community adopting a different moral conduct by using drugs, alcohol, crime and prostitution
- Increased living costs due to tourism pushing up property prices, and goods and services prices due to the visitors ‘buying power’
- Low paid jobs and seasonal employment often linked to the tourism industry
- Dependency on tourism as the main revenue generator, making the region vulnerable to economic changes such as fluctuation of currency, political changes.

Environmental impacts

Changing local conditions may result in the following positive environmental impact:

- Implementation of sustainable practices to preserve the environment and opportunity to become a leader in the field
- Opportunity to enhance preservation of endangered or threatened natural sites, animal species.



Changing local conditions may result in the following negative environmental impact:

- Threat to regional natural and cultural resources such as water supply, heritage sites if left un managed due to overuse
- Increased stress on existing buildings, facilities and infrastructure
- Increase in traffic, creating congestion
- Increase in pollution, littering, noise.

Cultural impacts

Changing local conditions may result in the following positive environmental impact:

- Overall cultural empowerment and increase sense of pride as locals become ambassadors for tourism in their region
- Opportunity for locals to share culture and educate visitors
- Opportunity to enhance the preservation of endangered or threatened aspects of the local culture, customs and community as interest by tourism in local culture helps preserving the culture, and its architecture, exhibits and artefacts.



Changing local conditions may result in the following negative environmental impact:

- Dilution of culture such as loss or reduce usage of indigenous dress code in favour or more modern clothes
- Misrepresentation of culture by focusing mainly on visual spectacles such as dances. This 'commodification' can be caused by unscrupulous tour operators to maximise revenue. It fails to properly represent and interpret the cultural background

2.3 Communicate research results to stakeholders

Introduction

As previously mentioned two ways communication is the key as success. A vital stage in assessing and planning tourism opportunities for local communities is to deliver the research results to all previously identified stakeholders as part of the initial consultation process.

Communication tools and process

Material presentation

It should be:

- Put together by a team or committee rather than just one person
- Targeted to all stakeholders which have been identified at the beginning of the research and will include:
 - Local communities
 - Wider community
 - Tourism bodies and organizations
 - Government authorities:
 - National
 - Local
 - Potential funding sources
 - Media
- Presented in:
 - Hard copies for:
 - specific meetings
 - Mail-outs
 - Electronic format posted on designated websites such as the host organization website
- The research findings need to be:
 - Prepared and written in a clear and easy language, relevant to the all stakeholders
 - Explain the research and its findings
 - Provide details, facts, figure, timelines
 - Include photographs and interviews with relevant key people.



Feedback

The feedback received will serve as a base to revise, consolidate the plan to ensure the final version is endorsed by all concerned parties from the government authorities to the tour operators on the grounds and the local community.

There are various efficient ways of collecting feedback. However feedback can be categorised under.

Formal, structured feedback such as:

- Written feedback:
 - Written completed survey
 - Dedicated feedback website page
 - Formal key identified stakeholder interviews

Informal, unstructured feedback also called opened feedback such as:

- Comments on social media if available such as face book, twitter
- Comments gathered while having an informal 'chat', anecdotal comments



The feedback can include:

- Positive and/or negative feedback
- Mention of other relevant issues which emerge as a result of the research such as:
 - Conflict arising
 - Unforeseen problems
 - Unforeseen outcomes
 - Unidentified indicators
- Initiate new topics for research data on the basis of emerging issues and/or community needs.

At the completion of the publicised consultation, feedback must be collated and match to the plan without prejudice: thus the importance of having a group responsible of the development versus a single person.

It is also essential that all feedback be properly reported. During a tourism plan consultation process in Australia, a tourism advisory panel representative did not properly feedback other relevant stakeholders, thus creating controversy and delaying the tourism plan implementation.

It is also important to contextualise feedback; keeping the 'big picture' in mind.

2.4 Use research results and feedback to guide future actions

Introduction

All collected data so far; with the feedback collected and recorded are now going to be used to guide future actions in the assessment and planning of tourism opportunities for local communities.

Research results and feedback integration

The information collected will now serve as a base for:

- Initial draft plan development or
- Existing draft plans modification, if applicable such as an expansion of a variation of previous tourism development plans.

It needs to be integrated into the formal draft plans under the relevant section. The draft tourism plan will include:

- An executive summary
- Data presenting the present regional, local tourism background including:
 - Overall regional framework in regards to existing official tourism plans, existing tourism activities and available infrastructure
 - Relevant existing organisational plans and strategies
 - Existing level of community resources:
 - Financial: representing existing funding and tourism revenues
 - Human: the people who are living in the area and could be involved in delivering the programs, plans
 - Physical: overall infrastructure and specifically related tourism infrastructure
 - Cultural resources such as specific local customs, festivals.

The draft plan need to take into consideration the:

- Level and frequency of community consultation obtained so far:
 - How many of the identified stakeholders have provided feedback: which community groups, key representatives, which industry associations and/or official agencies
 - How was the main feedback obtained: face to face meeting, on line comments
 - Nature of the feedback:
 - Mainly positive, negative
 - Which preferences emerged



- An in depth analysis of the impact of the plans on the community in general covering all potential aspects previously mentioned
- Recommendations in order to move to the draft plans stage:
 - Presentation stage
 - Approval stage
 - Implementation stage.



Further community consultation

Upon the completion of the draft plans, another round of consultation is to take place to:

- Inform, notify how their input is reflected in the draft/emerging plans
- When presenting the draft plans, make sure that the actions taken so far:
 - Data research
 - Consultation
 - Data integration
 are aligned to the local community:
 - Identified needs : more visitors or development of infrastructure to accommodate the existing number of visitors
 - Generally expressed and recorded local values communities such as:
 - The importance of developing the cultural awareness of the region
 - Ensuring any plan, development is sustainability friendly.

2.5 Confirm tourism opportunities to be pursued with the local communities and other relevant stakeholders

Introduction

Building on from the last point, identified and chosen opportunities to be pursued in the initial draft plans need to be validated with all the concerned parties. It is a significant stage and the following strategies can be applied:

How to confirm tourism opportunities to be pursued

The process needs to include all identified stakeholders from local communities, to authorities and tour operators.

It is recommended to use very similar strategies from the first consultation step covered in element 1. This will provide the stakeholders a feeling of familiarity and confidence in the consultation process and can include:

- Public meetings and reporting presentation
- Postings on the designated website and social media
- Media releases and interviews if applicable at this stage.

It is important to explain:

- Options identified in light of research and consultation:
- Represent research data factored in new and emerging information and input – which would simply not have been available at the start of the program
- Mention both positive and potential adverse impacts
- Maintain credibility with the local community by ensuring the information provided is:
 - Factual
 - Complete
 - Unbiased
 - Keep promises made – every host community awareness program will contain a public statement saying action will be taken as/where necessary to revise and adjust programs on the basis of feedback/research data and
 - Prove ongoing engagement with the local community and the program in order to obtain support from local communities and stakeholders.
- Promotes and encourage a frank and open dialogue for all identified stakeholders to speak and comment on the data researched, interpreted, the opportunities and the possibilities presented
- Organising information distribution channels to reach all stakeholders:
 - Enough face to face meetings, seminars and workshops
 - Enough lead time prior to meetings, seminars, workshops for stakeholders to get organized to attend
 - Publicised how, when the information: hard or/and soft copy will be disseminated
 - Provide enough time for all stakeholders to provide comments
- Be very clear as to how the local communities input is reflected
- In light of feedback obtained, the following actions and strategies might become part of the formal draft plans:
 - Receive, acknowledge and accept feedback indicating the proposed course of action are not acceptable by local communities and key stakeholders
 - Obtain support from local communities and key stakeholders to pursue nominated course of action
- Revise proposals based on negative comments to generate more acceptable courses of action.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Building from the project you have started for the previous element, you are required to interpret research results:

2.1 Analyse the information collected from all sources by:

- Classifying the data collected
- Verifying the data collected
- Quantifying the data collected, if applicable
- Using the data to generate trends, percentage, and ratios to better identify potential opportunities.

2.2. Identify the impacts of the research under the following categories:

- Social and economic impacts
- Environmental impacts
- Cultural impacts.

2.3. Plan how you will communicate your results by:

- Presenting copies of the report and findings to all identified stakeholders
- Seeking feedback
- Recording feedback.

2.4. Clarify how you will use your research results and feedback to:

- Develop initial draft plan
- Ensuring the plan is in line with the local community needs, wants and preferences
- Organising a new round of consultation with the local community

2.5 Confirm the tourism opportunities to be pursued with the local community and all other identified stakeholders:

- Hold meetings to explain identified options
- Present advantages and disadvantages of identified options ensuring the information is clear, factual and unbiased
- Solicit debate and feedback
- Record feedback
- Revise proposal on basis on feedback received and recorded.

Summary

Interpret research results

- Analyse the information collected from all sources
 - Clarify the data
 - Verify, quantify , manipulate the research data
 - Produce research report
- Identify impacts of the research:
 - Social
 - Environmental
 - Economic
 - Cultural
- Communicate research results to stakeholders:
 - Present research report copies to key stakeholders
 - Present report findings:
 - At local community meetings
 - To all external stakeholders
 - Seek and record feedback
- Use research results and feedback to guide future actions:
 - Develop initial draft plans
 - Modify existing draft plans
 - Integrate research data into plans
 - Ensure plans are aligned with local community needs, wants and preferences
 - Notify the local community as how their input is reflected
 - Confirm with local community the action to date is aligned with needs, wants and preferences
- Confirm tourism opportunities to be pursued with the local communities and other relevant stakeholders:
 - Hold meetings with all stakeholders
 - Explain advantages and disadvantages
 - Represent research data
 - Ensure the information is factual, complete and unbiased
 - Encourage debate and feedback
 - Obtain local communities and key stakeholders support
 - Receive and acknowledge feedback
 - Revise proposals on the basis of feedback.

Element 3:

Prepare formal draft plans

3.1 Seek assistance from external experts and relevant personnel

Introduction

The preparation of professional formal draft plans requires expert input to guarantee maximum clarity of the information and ease of understanding.

Professional assistance

Professional assistance can be obtained using

External experts

They can be consulted for their knowledge and expertise and will help with a broader and longer range view of the consequences of choices made for the local communities and all other stakeholder. They may include:

- Planning experts will inform and guide in relation to the potential consequences of:
 - The region, town, locality expansion such as infrastructure developments, public services facilities and amenities
- Environmental experts will inform and guide in relation to the potential consequences of:
 - Tourism increase on the eco system
 - Sustainability options to support the potential in visitors numbers
- Social demographers will inform and guide in relation to the potential consequences of:
 - Quality of life of the inhabitants or local people
 - Pattern of behaviour due to an increase in tourism
- Financial experts will inform and guide in relation to the potential consequences of:
 - Real cost of any tourism initiative and development and its economic consequences such as:
 - Creation of employment
 - Increase in local taxes revenues
 - Increased living costs due to visitors 'buying power'



It is important to note that some organisations might use their 'own' experts with a biased opinion:

- Government officers and agencies have access to:
 - Up to date tourism data and statistics
 - Potential funds such as grants
 - Authority to grants permits
- Key people from the local communities will contribute due to:
 - Local knowledge of:
 - People and their views, local culture
 - Events and traditions
 - Infrastructure.

3.2 Ensure draft plans reflect community interests and concerns

Introduction



Formal draft plans are the version 1 of the plans. Both content and format are important to make the draft plans 'user friendly' for all identified stakeholders to understand and comment on.

Even at the draft stage, plans also need to clearly and effectively assess and plan tourism opportunities for the local communities involved.

Regardless of the aim and content of the plan: from expanding an existing local Sunday market to opening a coastal resort, a well-researched, informed and constructed draft plan will address both communities interests and communities concerns.

Community interests and concerns:

The draft plans need to include:

- All initiatives and proposals initially discussed with all previously identified stakeholders
- All recorded consensus or opposition to potential tourism opportunities:
 - Which ones
 - Reasons for choice
- Are culturally appropriate, respecting the identified communities values
- Are environmentally appropriate , respecting the existing 'pristine' conditions as these are now highly sought after
- Prevent, as much as possible, 'tourism leakage' by making sure local resources, products are used

- Include policies and procedures to guide and regulate the proposed plans such as:
 - Ongoing consultation process
 - Transparency of process by making sure a group of people representing the majority of stakeholders and community such as a committee is in charge of the plan, not a single individual
 - Compliance with recognised national or regional accreditation such as listed on the state of Victoria website:
 - <http://www.tourism.vic.gov.au/business-tools-support/tourism-accreditation.html>
- Includes proposed realistic timelines, deadlines, schedules
- Includes potential contingencies plans.

3.3 Ensure plans reflect the business plans and direction of the host enterprise

Introduction

In addition to reflecting the community interest and concerns, the draft plans also need to reflect and integrate the host enterprise direction.

The host enterprise holds the responsibility of producing the draft plans. It is essential that those plans are in line its business direction and business plans.

To that effect, the following matters must be considered:

Matters to consider

Financial resources:

- Overall cost of producing the draft plans versus availability of funding. The host enterprise needs to know that the project will eventually be beneficial in terms of finance. However some organisations might undertake a project with no positive financial rewards but with the potential of more similar or bigger financially rewarding projects.



Human resources:

- The size of the organisation has a direct impact on the staffing level. The larger the organisation, the more staff they have. However the staff availability and expertise needs to be checked and confirmed before undertaking any such project involving research, consultation and production of professional plans even if there are in a draft format.

Physical resources:

- Physical resources include:
 - Office space
 - Hardware, software such as a dedicated website for the project on the host organization website, computers, laptops, iPads, mobile phones
 - Vehicles to travel to the local destination, if applicable, to go to conduct interviews, meet various business operators, stakeholders.

Timing and integration

- Timing:
 - How does the initiative fit with other established plans, projects the host enterprise is already involved with
 - Is it feasible to complete the research and subsequent draft plans, consultation phases with other already established plans and deadlines the host enterprise has committed for??
- Integration of plans with existing products and services being advertised and offered
 - Is the host enterprise already conducting research in the same region for another local community?
 - Is the host enterprise already involved in local development plans in the same region?
 - In light of the last 2 points, can the host enterprise still complete the project? Is there a potential conflict of interest?
- Most tourism plans span over 5 to 10 years. The host enterprise needs to determine if this time span fits with its own business plan and overall business direction before investing any more time, effort and resources into the project.



3.4 Identify training needs and training delivery methodologies

Introduction

An essential component of any tourism plan is the identification of both training needs and training methodologies as these elements are the corner stone of 'making it happen'.

The 2 phases may include:

Training needs identification

Training needs will dictate the type of training methodologies recommended in the draft plans

To determine training needs, the following is recommended:

Training needs analysis (TNA)

A TNA will support the establishment of training methodologies and training plans by establishing who needs training and in which specific areas : from guest customer service to specific food and beverage skills. It can be completed by:

- Conduct training needs analysis first with selected members of the local communities to get a 'snap shot' of the potential training gaps matching the potential local tourism development
- Organise demonstrations and tests to assess competency: it is important that those demonstrations and tests are delivered in a non-threatening manner, you do not want the local communities members to feel they are being examined, ranked , when this stage is part of the local consultation to determine and prepare plans

- Another step is to check the qualifications and competence of local communities members to match them best with identified training and skills needs
- The host enterprise credentials, abilities and experience also need to be assessed to determine if some of them have expertise required to deliver the identified training needs.

Training delivery methodologies

A range options can be considered to manage training delivery in the most efficient and cost effective manner. The range and type of options will vary according to the location of the local communities and nature of the draft plans. They can include:

Private providers

- Professional vocational training organisations can prepare workers to undertake tasks and responsibilities as required by the chosen tourism sector.

Host organisation training staff

- Host organisation staff with experience in similar projects can prepare the local community members by delivering on the job training.

Evaluate other training options such as:

Alternative training options might be considered due to:

- Region and/or local communities difficulty to access if in a remote location
- Maximise the training efficiency and delivery

And use:

- On line training, technology permitting
- Off campus, by organising workbooks for the theory component of the training workbooks
- A combination of face to face and on line.



3.5 Identify physical infrastructure needs for the local communities and the host enterprise

Introduction

Any new plans need to carefully consider the physical infrastructure required for both the local community and host enterprise. This is achieved by conducting a comparative analysis between the existing infrastructure and the required infrastructure to set up the proposed/draft plans. The inventory needs to cover for both:

Building and facilities

- New buildings and facilities required such as:
 - Potential new coastal resort development including resort itself, supporting infrastructure such as road and sea access
- Existing facilities alterations or additions such as:
 - Renovation or extension of existing buildings, workshops to offer to local craft men the opportunity to work from a central location easily accessible for visitors, supporting infrastructure such as road access, parking areas, restaurants, toilets
- Identification of all relevant buildings or extension permits and authorisations that will be required to proceed and establish the length of time those permits and/or authorisations will take to obtain.



Transport

Transport will cover

Transport to and within the area to promote and discuss initiatives during the consultation process.

Transport for the implementation stage such as:

- Air traffic, if applicable:
 - Is the size of the closest airport able to service an increase in traffic?
- Vehicles access:
 - Are there enough existing regional , local roads or tracks to accommodate an increase in traffic, which conditions are they in, will some maintenance work need to be conducted in, will new roads, tracks have to be opened?
- Are there enough parking areas for
 - Cars?
 - Buses?
 - How is pedestrian access?

Physical infrastructure potential impact

At this stage of the draft plans development, it is essential to carefully consider

- Potential infrastructure development or expansion impact by ensuring that the positives will outweigh the negative
 - The local community, local providers need to directly benefit, not a single outside operator
- The environmental impact will be kept to a minimum, leaving the smallest environmental footprint. It is important to note that due to the ever increasing importance of sustainability, being environmentally aware will help with a more positive response to any proposed draft tourism plans.

3.6 Identify resources that need to be supplied to the local communities to facilitate implementation of plans

Introduction

In addition to physical infrastructure needs for potential tourism opportunities, resources required by the local communities to facilitate the proposed draft plans implementation need to be identified. They can be categorised under specific headings such as:

- Financial
- Human resources
- Human services and prerequisites
- Provision of goods, services and equipment.

Financial resources

As previously mentioned, any potential tourism initiative needs to have the local communities support to succeed. Making a financial contribution to one or more nominated local initiatives as identified by the community will benefit the draft plans approval.

The funding may be available:

- In 'cash' or 'in kind'
 - Cash as in funding money
 - Kind as in provision of staff, physical resources.

The funding can come from:

- The individual businesses, groups or organisations proposing the program, project
- Government departments (national, state authorities and bodies) in terms of:
 - Grants, subsidies
 - Assistance and allowances
- Relevant industry associations and/or bodies
- A specific stakeholder, operator with a vested interest and wanting to create a more positive relationship and rapport with the local communities.



Human resources

Human resources are the people who will be involved in delivering programs, sessions. It is important to use the 'right people' able to:

- They are credible in the eyes of the projected audiences
- They have excellent communication skills – and can talk with identified target audiences
- They have brilliant interpersonal skills
- They have excellent supplementary skills – in terms of negotiation, conflict resolution, leadership
- They are knowledgeable about the project
- They present well
- They are passionate about the initiative and engaging in the way they communicate
- There are 'sufficient' of them to cope with scheduled sessions and activities
- They have relevant experience and presentation expertise
- They are of the 'right' gender, age, race, religion or culture where this has been identified as a genuine issue in relation to the community and/or the program.



They will provide the local communities with

- Relevant training, in turn providing
- Employment opportunities

Human and public services

Health care and medical services might be part of formal draft plans if the forecasted tourists, visitors increase level warrants an increase in:

- Numbers of health care practitioners such as doctors, nurses, pharmacists, dentists
- Health care and medical services locations:
 - Local hospital expansion
 - New medical centre to be opened.

Public safety and security is another issue requiring careful consideration. An unfortunate, well known consequence of tourism development is a potential local increase in theft and crime. In light of this knowledge, any draft tourism plan now needs to include a strategy to guarantee the safety and security of the local communities and visitors alike. This can be achieved by:

- Increased number of local police
- Use of outside security contractors at specific times such as:
 - During construction and operational phase of a new coastal resort
 - During identified 'peak season' such as a festival, school holidays.

Provision of equipment, facilities, goods, services

Equipment

The equipment the local communities' essential to facilitate the tourism plans implementation needs to be identified and a couple of examples are:

- Additional transport:
 - Buses, trains, boats, taxis
- Range of technological equipment required:
 - Mobile phones, beepers, GPS, email, internet capacity and capability.



Facilities, goods and services

Access of all essential facilities, goods and services are also relevant to the tourism plans implementation in order to meet the tourists, visitors' needs and expectations and will vary according to the opportunities and tourism development chosen.

The facilities, good and services expected by day visitors attending a local cultural festival are vastly different from the facilities, goods and services expected by adventure tourism visitors.

Common facilities, goods and services might be:

- Infrastructure from roads to toilets
- Transport
- Local health care, medical and security services.

Specific facilities, goods and services might be:

- Day visitors:
 - Convenient access
 - Enough car parks
 - Enough toilets
 - Sufficient number of food and beverage outlets not to wait too long to get food, whether it is just a sandwich or a meal in a restaurant
- Adventure tourists:
 - Enough 'adventure' activities
 - Adequate, simple accommodation.

3.7 Incorporate the environmental, social, cultural and economic interests of the local communities into the plans

3.8 Ensure plans are culturally and environmentally sensitive

Introduction

If well managed, tourism can have a positive role in the environmental, social, cultural and economic fabric of the local communities and represent a significant development opportunity. However unregulated or poorly managed tourism development and operations can lead to very damageable impacts.

It must also be noted that working in the tourism industry offers a unique opportunity to raise awareness among:

- Visitors
- Staff
- Service providers
- The local community.

About the benefits of sustainable living, and enhances environmental best practice in the region.

Therefore, when preparing formal draft plans those topics must be taken into consideration on 2 levels: local community social and economic interests and overall cultural and environmental interests and sensitivity.

Environmental factors and sensitivity

As the environment changes and concern about these changes grows, there is an increasing need to be aware of the impact that businesses have on the environment.

The plans should address how to ensure:

- Minimum environmental impact of tourism related development by using environmentally sensitive and sustainable operation
- Resources are put into the protection of the environment and action is taken in relation to:
 - Sustainability
 - Conservation:
 - Animals and plants are protected, particularly endangered ones
 - Regeneration, if applicable
 - Waste management.



Social and economic factors

The plans should address how to ensure, as previously mentioned

- Economic diversification and general economic benefits to the local community
- Involve local businesses in the overall economic, entrepreneurial and promotional aspects of the potential opportunities initiative/s so they can benefit from what occurs.

Cultural factors and sensitivity

The plans should include strategies to ensure, as previously mentioned:

- Heritage is acknowledged and cultural empowerment takes place locals become ambassadors for tourism in their region
- Thus avoiding cultural trivialisation and deterioration is avoided
- Historic sites and buildings are protected and conserved by strict rules and regulations in regards to, for example, maximum numbers of visitors allowed per day in a specific historic site.



3.9 Maintain ongoing communication and consultation throughout the planning process

Introduction

A successful communication strategy needs to go beyond the initial approved plan presentation. Ongoing dialogue and consultation give stakeholders and communities the chance, opportunity to be fully part of the process and regular updates need to occur to keep all parties informed throughout the planning process.

Regular updates

Those updates must be scheduled at regular publicised intervals.

Objective

- Updates on the progress must be provided for all stakeholders and community having interest or and being affected by the plan so they are kept informed on what is happening and how. Timeframes
- When is it happening: is the plan on schedule? Actions detailed in the plan must be implemented according to approved schedule

It is important to remember to:

- Be aware of all facts and figures
- Be aware of previous feedback
- Know the names of relevant people and places
- Appreciate the connections and relationships between the various aspects of the proposed plans
- Be constantly aware of the features, benefits, advantages and disadvantages of the project
- Understand and be able to explain the rationale/s of the plan.



To ensure continuity, it is recommended to follow the same information dissemination channels taking into account which media have been the most successful so far.

Those mediums can be:

- Public meetings
- Workshops
- Seminars
- Media such as newspapers, social media, newsletters.

3.10 Develop a clear strategic and tactical focus for plans that are made

Introduction

The last step of any formal draft plan preparation is to develop a clear and strategic focus to guide all concerned parties and successfully move forward.

This topic can be considered as the project management aspect of the plan. It needs to include:

- A SWOT analysis
- Host organisation strategies to achieve identified outcomes
- Clear project mission and goals
- Clear priorities with timelines
- Measurement criteria to ensure the success of the initiative
- Measurement criteria to the monitoring of the initiative
- Specific written plans to guide the various phases of the implementation
- Establishment of clear communication channels and responsibilities
- Establishment of a relevant accounting structure to support funds and resources allocation.



Strategic and tactical focus

The SWOT analysis mentioned earlier is the first measurements instrument to inform and implement the formal draft plans.

SWOT analysis

A SWOT analysis is the process of gathering together information/data on both the internal and external environments to determine the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities that are present as well as the threats relating to the situation being considered.

A SWOT analysis is a fundamental pre-requisite for any research or marketing activity to help determine the situation being considered.

A SWOT analysis may also be known as:

- A Situational analysis
- A Situation analysis
- A SWOT matrix.

Internal factors

The internal factors in a SWOT analysis are the factors present within a business, organisation or agency (essentially, the body proposing the host community awareness program).

They are the 'Strengths' and 'Weaknesses' of the entity.

What is strength for one body may be a weakness for another.

For example:

- A business may have extensive tourism experience and loads of previous engagement with host community awareness program – this would obviously be a significant Strength

Another organisation may have no such experience and expertise so this would be a Weakness for them

- One body may have substantial financial and other resources to enable research and community consultancy to occur – so this would be a positive/Strength

Another body may have no or very limited resources so this would be a negative/Weakness.

To an extent these factors are controllable as the organisations have the power to impact them – they can (for example) work to gain more experience and expertise, or take action to raise more money or obtain additional resources.

External factors

External factors are those which exist outside the business, body or entity.

They are the factors which are to be found in the target host communities and are divided into:

- Opportunities – which are factors which can be exploited or taken advantage of in relation to tourism initiatives in the community
- Threats – which represent things which might prejudice, jeopardise or otherwise negatively influence a tourism initiative unless they are effectively addressed.

Some threats cannot be effectively addressed.

External factors are regarded as being uncontrollable in that the business/entity undertaking the research is unable to (significantly) impact the relevant factors.

Websites

More information on SWOT analysis can be found at:

- <http://www.traveldailynews.com/columns/article/20490/a-swot-analysis-of-asean> - A SWOT analysis of ASEAN tourism
- <http://www10.iadb.org/intal/intalcdi/PE/2012/10151.pdf> - Chapter 2 of this document (ASEAN Tourism marketing strategy 2012 – 2015)
- <http://www.ukessays.com/essays/marketing/a-swot-analysis-of-tourism-in-malaysia-marketing-essay.php> - A SWOT analysis of tourism in Malaysia
- <http://skift.com/2013/10/29/swot-analysis-of-a-national-tourism-market-australias-example/> - SWOT analysis of a national tourism market: Australia's example
- <http://create.ly/diagram/example/g86xkkio/SWOT+Analysis+of+the+Tourism+Industry> – SWOT analysis of the tourism industry.



Outcomes measurements

Mission, goals and priorities

The project management aspect of the plan includes a close monitoring of all activities.

All the research information, interpretation, feedback collected is now been used.

When the proposed outcomes have been clearly identified, the host organisation needs to draw formal draft plans that:

- Clearly detail how the identified outcomes can be achieved by:
 - Identifying outcomes
 - Identifying protocols to be followed to meet those outcomes
 - Identify and explain the process parameters
- Clearly detail the best chosen strategies to optimise benefits from the local communities while minimising negative impacts
- Have completed an extensive competitors projects and products analysis
- Have enough industry influence and efficient network to protect the initiative against the competition
- Generate:
 - Clear mission for the initiative and
 - Clear goals to achieve reflecting:
 - Results of community consultation
 - Input made by relevant stakeholders
 - Government policies, initiatives
 - Identified economic imperatives
 - Need to care for the local environment
 - Action being taken in relation to tourism activities/initiatives by other similar communities in the region/local area.



Progress tracking and recording

Clear sign posts need to be integrated into any plan in order to track and record the progress of established goals, objectives, targets

- Clear priorities with timelines
- Measurement criteria to ensure the success of the initiative
- Measurement criteria to the monitoring of the initiative

Initial timelines and measurement criteria will be tracked, monitored and recorded against the initial deadlines and schedules to determine for example:

- Is the implementation timetable being followed? Are there any delays in regards to:
 - Permits

- Buildings construction, upgrade
- Recruitment and training
- What is the cause of the delay?
- Administrative reason
- Adverse weather
- Lack of potential staff members

Nowadays, numerous measurements are available and the host enterprise will need to decide which ones are best suited to the plan.

One measurement instrument commonly used is called KPI (Key Performance Indicator) and easily indicates whether the initiative's objectives have been met.

The table below shows a KPI example

If one of the KPIs was to secure \$100,000 from grants and sponsorship, how much funds have been secured so far?

KPI	Target	Actual
Secure in grants and sponsorship	\$100,000 by the end of July	\$80,000 \$60,000 from government \$20,000 from sponsorship

A table format is recommended to deliver the information in a clear manner.

Again, depending on the proposed plan, initiative and the inclusions, KPI s may include how to measure success of the initiative and how to monitor the implementation phase including human physical resources data.

In addition, there are numerous programs management software programs are available to use.

Written plan

How to professionally write plan was covered in element 3.1.

The proposed written are designed to guide the implementation of the various identified aspects of the proposed project, initiative and must clearly specify:

- Timelines, milestones for each aspect of the proposed project
- Clear communication channels
- Clear responsibilities
- Relevant accounting structure in regards to resources allocation and control.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

You are now required to prepare formal draft plans for the chosen local community.

You are required to:

3.1 Seek assistance from external experts and relevant personnel such as

- Specialist experts (Planning, Environmental, Social demographers if you think it is applicable)
- Government officers and agencies.

3.2. Ensure that the draft plan reflect the local community interest and concerns.

3.3. Ensure that the draft plan reflects the business plans and direction of your organisation, the host enterprise taking into account:

- Financial
- Human
- Physical resources
- Timelines.

3.4. Identify training needs and training delivery methodologies:

- Undertake a local Training Needs Analysis
- Undertake assessment of the local community competences to match the potential tourism opportunities
- Assess internal staff and expertise to deliver training
- Decide upon the training methodology or methodology most appropriate, explain the reason for your choice.

3.5 Identify the physical infrastructure needs for both the local community and your organisation. This section needs to look at:

- Infrastructure
- Transport
- Impact.

3.6 Identify resources required by the local community for the successful plans implementation such as:

- Financial resources
- Human resources
- Human and public services
- Others.

3.7 & 3.8 Make sure you incorporate the following to the draft plans

- Local environmental factors and interests
- Local social and economic interests
- Local cultural factors and interests.

3.9 Detail the steps you will follow to maintain on going communication throughout the planning process.

3.10 Develop a clear strategic and tactical focus for your plan including:

- SWOT analysis
 - Mission and goals for the proposed plan
 - Clearly defined KPI
 - Clearly defined measurement criteria
 - Clearly defined monitoring criteria.
-

Summary

Prepare formal draft plans

- Seek assistance from external experts and relevant personnel:
 - Key people from local community
 - Experts : financial experts, planning experts, environmental experts, social demographers
 - Government officers and agencies
 - Host organisation manager.
 - Ensure draft plans reflect community interests and concerns
 - Ensure plans reflect the business plans and direction of the host enterprise:
 - Funding availability
 - Timing of initiative within established plans
 - Physical resources availability to support plans
 - Integration of plans with existing products and services
 - Short term and long term business objectives.
 - Identify training needs and training delivery methodologies:
 - Undertaking training needs analysis
 - Assess internal staff ability and expertise to deliver course of action
 - Organise local communities competency assessment
 - Check local communities members credentials
 - Use professional training providers services
 - Use host organisation staff to deliver on-the-job training
 - Evaluate alternative training options.
 - Identify physical infrastructure needs for the local community and the host enterprise:
 - Building and facilities needed versus existing building and facilities
 - Permits and authorizations approval
 - Transport requirements
 - Ensure physical infrastructure will have a positive impact on destination, local communities and minimum impact on environment
 - Identify resources that need to be supplied to the local communities to facilitate implementation of plans:
 - Cash or other payment
 - Training and employment opportunities
 - Health care and medical services
 - Access to and/or provision of facilities, service and goods, equipment
 - Safety and security requisites
 - Incorporate the environmental, social, cultural and economic interest of the local communities into the plans
 - Ensure the plans are culturally and environmentally sensitive
- Maintain on going communication and consultation throughout the planning process

- Develop a clear strategic and tactical focus for plans that are made:
 - Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats (SWOT) analysis
 - Strategies to achieve identified outcomes
 - Generation of mission and goals
 - Priority clarification
 - Establish success measurement criteria
 - Establish implementation monitoring criteria
 - Produce written plans to guide implementation
 - Describe relationship between host organisation, local communities and key stakeholders
 - Establish effective communication channels
 - Establish relevant accounting structure to support project, funds and resources allocation
 - Establish individual roles, responsibilities and scopes of authority.

Element 4: Present draft plans

4.1 Submit plans for consideration by the local communities and other relevant key stakeholders

Introduction

As previously mentioned, draft plans are the very first version of the regional plan. Both content and format are important to make the draft plans easy to understand for the local communities and all relevant key stakeholders.

Regardless of the aim and content of the plan : from expanding an existing local Sunday market to opening a new coastal resort, an efficient , the draft plans need to be:

- Professionally prepared, well-constructed
- Include all research results, interpretation, findings
- Formally presented to all parties concerned.

This submission phase is aimed to:

- Explanation of all plans
- Clearly explain and justify host organisation position in regards to recommendations
- Include a discussion on the implementation phase of the project
- Solicit and record feedback.

Professionally prepared plans

Professionally prepared plans need to:

- Include an executive summary for ease of understanding the 'big picture' and the aim of the draft plans
- Clearly state specific allocation of:
 - Tasks from project manager to liaison officer between all stakeholders so it is very clear 'who' does 'what'
 - Resources such as:
 - Financial resources: state funding, grants
 - Human resources: labour force recruitment and training
 - Responsibilities who is in charge of marketing, who is in charge of meeting financial deadlines, who is in charge of meeting human resources deadline such as training completion



- Aligns the plan objectives to SMART:
 - **Specific:** are your objectives clearly stated?
 - **Measurable:** what units of measure are being used?
 - **Accurate:** is the information, data used the latest and correct?
 - **Realistic-Relevant:** are your objectives reasonable?
 - **Trackable:** Time-related: what is your timing in regards to your objectives?
- Establishes proper methods of measuring whether objectives are being achieved in accordance with the time schedule such as using Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) as just mentioned.

KPI can be categorised into:

- Economic indicators: tourist arrivals
- Social Indicators : job creations
- Environmental indicators :sustainable tourism, international environmental standards

Example of key performance indicators can be: compliance, market share percentage, product quality, increase visitors' number by a certain percentage, and will vary according to the aim of the regional tourism plan.

Formal presentation of draft plans

The formal presentation can be seen as a stepping stone of any tourism project. It is the culmination of, in most cases, months of work and consultation. The formal draft plans need to be submitted to all the previously identified stakeholders such as:

- Government departments
- Tourism operators
- Industry associations
- Environment groups
- Local operators
- The local community/communities involved.

It is imperative that all stakeholders be given an opportunity to make themselves familiar with the draft plans. This can be achieved by using the communication channels established during the research and initial consultation stage from:

- Face to face meetings
- Media release
- Posting on the host organization website
- Hard copies readily available to all concerned stakeholders.



Explanation of all plans and defending positions

As previously highlighted, the communication process is crucial to the success of any tourism plans, projects.

All parts of the plans must be clearly explained such as:

- Plans rationale
- Strategies and tactics to implement to ensure the plans success
- Detailed internal and external structures pertinent to the plans success
- Clear projected outcomes for all concerned stakeholders
- Detailed resources allocation.

The host organization must also justify the selected, proposed tourism opportunities by clearly documenting and demonstrating that the option/s chosen have been carefully researched, considered and will benefit the majority of the concerned stakeholders.

New issues identified

During the research stage and/or research interpretation stage, new issues might have been identified resulting in unintended, potential changes to the plans and directly impacting the local communities such as:

- A change of zoning that lead to changes to the proposed location for a new resort
- A change of classification such as world heritage listing will result in more stringent rules and regulations for any expansion of tours, camping grounds
- A reduction of whale watching permits as the plan was proposing an expansion of the whale watching tourism, therefore jeopardizing the plans.



Implementation phase

The proposed plans also need to include information to be discussed in regards to the implementation stage such as:

- Proposed implementations methods and action to follow and apply
- Proposed schedule to implement the proposed plans
- Proposed progress and other reports according to organizational requirements
- Proposed contingency plans
- Keep on involving the local communities and all concerned stakeholders on an ongoing basis.

Feedback

As mainly covered under element 2.3

Feedback can be:

- Formal
- Informal.

Feedback can be obtained by:

- Face to face meetings
- Informal chats
- Interviews
- Feedback forms
- On the host organization website
- Via dedicated social media sites.



Once more, all feedback must be recorded, collated and analysed.

4.2 Amend plans on the basis of feedback received

Introduction

Similar to the communication stage as part of the research interpretation stage, the feedback received will serve as a base to amend the plans taking into account all concerned parties from the government authorities to the tour operators on the grounds and the local community.

Keys in amending plans

The main critical point is:

- Address every issue which means:
 - Never ignore an issue or question raised
 - Generate a reply, suggestion that will be acceptable to most stakeholders.

It needs to be understood that not all feedback can be taken into account. There will be times when issues cannot be resolved despite all previous attempts at explanation, discussions, consultation, investigation and compensation.

Positive actions in revising plans may include:

- Creation of enhanced objectives supported by the majority of the stakeholders
- Amendment/reduction of targets
- Increase funding/resources to help achieve initial targets
- Provision of more time for objectives to be achieved
- Include/upgrade risk management protocols relating to proposed program.

4.3 Re-present revised plans for approval

Introduction

When representing the plans, the host organization needs to:

- Highlight again the benefits of the proposed plans to the community, all other concerned parties and the media
- Ensure the community leaders and opinion makers feedback has been integrated into the revised plans
- Promote successes and positive outcomes that will flow from the revised plans implementation
- Present the revised plan proposed implementation stage.



At this point in time, the aim is to gain final approval and support to move to the implementation phase.

This involves both official approval and local communities' approval.

Official approval

The plan must be approved by the relevant authorities, bodies for approval prior to implementation. Depending on the country, region, and the authorities granting the official permission to can be:

- National such as Federal Ministry of Tourism in Australia
- State such as Victoria Tourism in the state of Victoria, Australia
- Local such as the local city council or shire.

Community approval

As already mentioned community approval is critical to the success of any regional tourism plan. General approval by all or most of the community members will ensure the next stage: the implementation stage can proceed.

Using the same information dissemination mediums as for the initial plan presentation will guarantee to keep the communication and dialogue happening.

Revised plan implementation stage

Revised plan implementation follows the same steps as the initial plans:

- Communication with all concerned stakeholders
 - To advise of the implementation of the revised plan
 - To maintain ongoing consultation
- Follow actions outlined in the plan and monitor implementation.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

To complete the last step of your work: presenting the draft plan, you are required to:

4.1 Submit the plan for consideration by local community and other relevant key stakeholders by:

- Formally presenting professionally prepared plan
- Explain the plan:
 - Strategies, tactics, outcomes
 - New issues identified
 - Implementation phase
- Solicit and record feedback.

4.2. Amend the plan in light of feedback received.

4.3. Re-present the plan for approval.

Summary

Present draft plans

- Submit plans for consideration by the local community and other relevant key stakeholders:
 - Formal presentation to all relevant stakeholders
 - In depth plans explanation
 - Identification of new issues with potential impact on the local communities
 - Soliciting and recording feedback
 - Defending and justifying host organisation and stakeholders positions
 - Discussion on project implementation
- Amend plans on the basis of feedback received
- Represent revised plans for approval.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Barber, Brian, & Kastarlak, Bulent I, 2010, *Fundamentals of planning and developing tourism*, Prentice Hall, USA

Blakely, Edward James & Leigh, Nancey Green 2013, *Planning local economic development: theory and practice*, Fifth edition, Los Angeles SAGE.

Chan, Yolande E & Dixon, Jeffrey A & Dukelow, Christine R & EBSCOhost 2013, *Revitalizing rural economies a guide for practitioners*, McGill-Queen's University Press, Montreal

Diaz, P. (Anthropologist), (editor of compilation.) 2015, *Tourism as a tool for development*, Southampton WIT Press

Hall, Colin Michael, 2008, *Tourism planning: policies, processes and relationships*, 2nd edition, Prentice Hall, United Kingdom

Phillips, Rhonda, (editor of compilation.) & Pittman, Robert H., (editor of compilation.) 2015, *An introduction to community development*, 2 Edition, New York Routledge.

Trainee evaluation sheet

Assess and plan tourism opportunities for local communities

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Assess and plan tourism opportunities for local communities

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Research local tourism opportunities			
1.1	Consult with the local community to obtain their involvement and input	☐	☐
1.2	Identify possible tourism opportunities for local communities	☐	☐
1.3	Identify research needs for the local communities	☐	☐
1.4	Conduct research on general tourism trends and data	☐	☐
1.5	Conduct research on the local area and communities	☐	☐
Element 2: Interpret research results			
2.1	Analyse the information collected from all sources	☐	☐
2.2	Identify impacts of the research	☐	☐
2.3	Communicate research results to stakeholders	☐	☐
2.4	Use research results and feedback to guide future actions	☐	☐
2.5	Confirm tourism opportunities to be pursued with the local communities and other relevant stakeholders	☐	☐
Element 3: Prepare formal draft plans			
3.1	Seek assistance from external experts and relevant personnel	☐	☐
3.2	Ensure draft plans reflect community interests and concerns	☐	☐
3.3	Ensure plans reflect the business plans and direction of the host enterprise	☐	☐
3.4	Identify training needs and training delivery methodologies	☐	☐
3.5	Identify physical infrastructure needs for the local communities and the host enterprise	☐	☐
3.6	Identify resources that need to be supplied to the local communities to facilitate implementation of plans	☐	☐
3.7	Incorporate the environmental, social, cultural and economic interests of the local communities into the plans	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
3.8	Ensure plans are culturally and environmentally sensitive	☐	☐
3.9	Maintain ongoing communication and consultation throughout the planning process	☐	☐
3.10	Develop a clear strategic and tactical focus for plans that are made	☐	☐
Element 4: Present draft plans			
4.1	Submit plans for consideration by the local communities and other relevant key stakeholders	☐	☐
4.2	Amend plans on the basis of feedback received	☐	☐
4.3	Re-present revised plans for approval	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

